

Chapter-6

VOICE

The verb in English occurs in two special forms in relation to the 'doer' of the action. The first is the Active form and the second the Passive form. It is easy to identify a Passive verb as it contains be +v₃ (past participle) structure. The sentence using the Active form of the verb is said to be in Active Voice while the one using the Passive form of the verb is said to be in Passive Voice.

The diagram below shows how sentences in the Active form are changed into the Passive form :

Active	Subject	Verb	Object
			(tense)
Passive	(new) Subject be	New form V ₃ (Past Participle)	Object
Present and Past Indef. (is, am, are /was/were)	Continuous Tenses is/am/are/was/were (being)	Perfect Tenses has/have/had (been)	to-infinitive (to be) Modals (be)

	Active Voice	Passive Voice
1. Present Simple	Ist form of the verb +s/es	is/are/am + third form
2. Past Simple	do/does (not) + Ist form of the verb	is/are/am (not)+third form
3. Present Continuous	2nd form of the verb	was/were (not) + 3rd form
4. Past Continuous	is/are/am (not) + Ist form + ing	is/are/am (not) + being + 3rd form
5. Present Perfect	was/were (not) Ist form + ing	was/were (not) + being + 3rd form
6. Past Perfect	has/have (not) + 3rd form	has/have (not) been + 3rd form
7. Future Perfect	had (not) + 3rd form	had (not) been + 3rd form
8. Modal verb	will/shall (not) have + 3rd form	will/shall (not) have been + 3rd form
	will, shall,	will, shall
	would, should, can,	would, should, can
	could, may, might	could, may, might
	must, ought to	must, ought to
	Ist form of verb	be 3rd form
9. Infinitive	to	to be
	Ist form	3rd form

Main uses of the Passive Voice :

- When the person doing the action (the agent) is not known, or when it is unnecessary to mention the agent.
e.g. My Pen has been stolen.
Milk is often sold in cartons.
- To emphasise the action or event rather than the agent.
e.g. Letters are collected from the boxes, taken to the sorting office, sorted and then sent to the given addresses.
- To avoid using 'you' or 'one' when making an impersonal statement.
e.g. Taking photographs in the museum is forbidden.'
Children are not allowed in the bar.

Exercises for Practice

1. *Change the voice in the following sentences :*

- (a) Sita writes a letter.
- (b) He killed the lion.
- (c) They will help you.
- (d) He was eating an orange.
- (e) The nurse is looking after the patient.
- (f) I have completed my work.
- (g) I had learnt my lesson.
- (h) His enemies have defeated him.

SPACE FOR ANSWERS

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2. *Complete the passage with either the Active or Passive forms of the verbs given in the box :*

block, press, blow, cause, live, sweep, cut, rescue

Damage worth millions of rupees (a) by a storm which (b) across coastal areas of Orissa. The army (c) into service. Many people (d)..... from the floods by the army. Winds (e) at the speed of about 150 kms. an hour in some places. Roads (f) by fallen trees. Electricity lines (g) and people had to without electricity for several hours.

SPACE FOR ANSWERS

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3. *Change the Voice of the following passage :*

Raju killed a snake with a stick. He threw it in a pond nearby. He played cricket for some time. Then he plucked some flowers to make garlands. He put the garland on Lord Krishna's statue.

SPACE FOR ANSWERS

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4. *Look at some newspaper headlines given below. Then use the information in the headlines to complete the sentences that follow (select the proper form of the verb to be used).*

(a) THREE PASSENGERS CRUSHED

..... to death when they fell from of roof-top of a bus.

(b) FIFTY HUTS DESTROYED IN FIRE

A fire broke out in a resettlement colony in which.....
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(c) LEOPARD BEATEN TO DEATH

The Police report that a by villagers when it tried to attack them.

(d) SUSPECT ARRESTED

London police report that a suspect involved in the Bomb Blast Case

(e) TWO STABBED

It is learnt that in two separate incidents yesterday.

(f) INDIANS TO PAY MORE FOR PAK CITIZENSHIP

Indians applying for Pakistani citizenship will

5. *The Passive voice can be used in several tenses. Complete the following table, filling in the blanks with suitable form of the verbs :*

	<i>Tenses</i>	<i>Subject</i>	<i>Verb 'to be'</i>	<i>Past Participle</i>
1.	(Future Indefinite)	Lunch		taken at 1 p.m. here.
2.	(Past Continuous)	The house		built.
3.	(Present Perfect)	The lost purse.		found.
4.	(Past Simple)	The culprit		produced in the court.
5.	(Past Continuous)	The door		repaired
6.	(Past Perfect)	A suitable action		
7.	(Past Indefinite)	My proposal		posted.
8.	(Past Perfect)	Letters		

6. *Complete each of the following sentences using the correct form of the verb given in the bracket :*

1. This historical monument (build) thousands of years ago.
2. The money (steal) by Mr. Gupta's servant yesterday.
3. The largest 9-way flyover (construct) last month in Delhi.
4. Seema's marriage outfit (design) by the famous designer Ritu Beri.
(Present Perfect)
5. A letter (receive) by Mohan 10 days after it (post).

7. *In the sentences given below, change the verb into Passive form :*

- a. Robbers raided the bank.
- b. The terrorists injured ten people.
- c. They took away all the cash.
- d. They also shot the security guards.
- e. The police have arrested the thieves.

8. *Given below is an outline. Using the outline in the box, fill in the blanks in the passage below:*

New School on the outskirts of Delhi. Is located in Tijara (90 km. drive from Delhi). Brainchild of legal expert Vidya Sagar. Uniform syllabus. Yearly boarding and tuition expenses believed to be around 1.25 lacs.

A new school (a) of Delhi. It (b) in Tijara, 90kms. from Delhi. It is the brainchild of legal expert Vidya Sagar. (c) introduced in this school. It (d) that yearly expenses would be around 1.25 lacs per year.

9. *Read the following set of instructions and fill in the blanks :*

HOW TO MAKE TEA

- i. Take a kettle.
- ii. Put half a cup of water in it.
- iii. Put it on the gas stove.
- iv. Switch on the stove.
- v. When the water begins to boil, add a teaspoonful of tea leaves.
- vi. Add half a cup of milk and some sugar to it.
- vii. Switch off the stove when the mixture starts boiling.
- viii. Pour the mixture into a cup through a sieve (sifter).

A kettle was taken. Half a cup of water in it. It on the gas stove. The stove When the water began to boil, a teaspoonful of tea leaves to it. Half a cup of milk and some sugar to the mixture. The stove when the mixture started boiling. It was a cup through a sieve.

10. *Complete the passage with either the Active or Passive forms of the verbs given in the box :*

admit	register	hit	arrest
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A Ludhiana BJP leader, Radhey Shyam by a truck near Ambala bus depot last night. Radhey Shyam to a hospital in the city. The truck driver Hari Singh by the police. A case of causing death due to rash and negligent driving against him.

11. *Change the Voice in the following passage :*

A truck hit a bus yesterday. The carelessness of the driver caused the accident. The local people took the injured passengers to hospital. The police have arrested the driver.

SPACE FOR ANSWERS

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12. *Change the Voice in the following passage :*

We saw a magic show yesterday. The magician showed a number of wonderful tricks. First he took off his hat and put it on the table. He covered the hat with a piece of cloth. Then he moved a stick over the hat. He then took the cloth off. Out of the hat he pulled out three chickens.

SPACE FOR ANSWERS

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13. *Complete the passage with the Passive forms of the verbs given in the box:*

dig	select	prepare	lower	cover	sprinkle
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First, a plant from the nursery. Then a hole where the plant was to be placed into the soil. The soil by mixing manure with it. The plant into the hole carefully. The roots were with the prepared soil. Some water on the plant.

14. *Complete the following passage using the verbs in brackets in the Passive Voice:*

At least four crore worth of imported newsprint (a) (destroy) in yesterday's fire in one of the godowns outside Cochin port. The fire which broke out in the afternoon (b) (bring) under control only this morning. Fire fighting operations (c) (hamper). by the delay and difficulty in removing the huge newsprint rolls from outside the godown. The godown (d) (hire) for the Hindustan Newsprint by a private 'clearing and forwarding' agent. The port operations (e) (affect) due to the incident.

15. *Read the following set of instructions for the servicing of an air conditioner and complete the paragraph that follows, using Passive form of the verbs used:*

1. Dismantle the air conditioner.
2. Take out the main machine from inside the box.

3. Blow off the entire dust from the body with the help of a vacuum cleaner.
4. Wash the body with a spray of water from a pipe.
5. Let it dry in the sun for about an hour.
6. Fix it back into place.

The air conditioner is The main machine is out from inside the box. The entire dust from the body with the help of a vacuum cleaner. The body with a spray of water from a pipe. It then in the sun for about an hour. It is now back into place.

16. *Change the Voice in the following passage :*

Sita is singing a song. She sings film songs as well as folk songs. All like her. She helps the poor with the money she earns. God will certainly bless her. The country needs such artists.

SPACE FOR ANSWERS

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17. *Change the Voice in the following passage :*

1. The gardener is plucking flowers.
2. Boys are flying kites.
3. He is laughing at the beggar.
4. The peon was ringing the bell.
5. The watchman had already opened the gate.

SPACE FOR ANSWERS

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18. *Rewrite the following sentences in the notice format using the Passive Voice.: (See example 1)*

1. We do not allow cameras inside.

Ans : Cameras are not allowed inside.

2. We do not allow children below 12 in this show.
3. We book seats here.
4. We require a shop assistant immediately.
5. We do not allow vehicles inside the campus.

19. *Complete the passage with the Passive form of verbs given in the brackets:*

A three year old girl (rescue) by the police last Tuesday. She (kidnap) by a neighbour for ransom. The mother informed the police about the missing girl. The probe (supervise) by the DSP himself. More than 50 residents (interrogate). Ultimately, Danny, one of the residents of the colony, admitted the crime and disclosed where the girl (hide).

20. *Read the newspaper headlines given below and complete the sentences that follow:*

1. RAIN KILLS OVER TWO DOZEN

Kathmandu : About in the remote villages of north-western Kalikot district in the rains that hit the area.

2. LARGEST DISCOVERY OF DINOSAUR EGGS

Lerida : More than 100 eggs of dinosaur in north-eastern Spain.

3. PAK DEFEATED BY A BIG MARGIN

The Pakistani cricket team in the first one-dayer by a big margin yesterday. The match at Lahore in the Gaddafi Stadium.

4. BUSH ACCORDED WARM WELCOME

President Bush of USA a warm welcome on his arrival in India this year. He by the Prime Minister himself at the Delhi airport.

5. UNDERGROUND TUNNEL UNEARTHED

A half-dug underground tunnel by the police personnel inside the jail compound yesterday. The digging by the two convicts undergoing life terms in the jail.

6. COLD WAVE CLAIMS 37 LIVES

The cold wave prevailing in Punjab for more than a week has worsened further. There a fresh snowfall in the Himalayas. Meanwhile 37 lives so far by the cold wave.

7. RICH HOMAGE PAID TO MAHATMA GANDHI; STATUE UNVEILED

Rich homage to the Father of the Nation, Mahatma Gandhi, on the occasion of his birth anniversary, yesterday. A bronze statue of the great visionary on the occasion.

8. **D.J. SIMPSON ACQUITTED**
In the judgement given today by an American court, the famous football legend D.J. Simpson of murder charges against him.
9. **IDOLS IMMERSSED IN RIVER**
The ten-day Dushehra festival comes to an end today when all the idols carried in a procession in the Ganges by the devotees.
10. **THREE MILITANTS KILLED, SEVEN ARRESTED**
During the past 24 hours and seven have been arrested in the Kashmir Valley. A large number of weapons were also seized from those arrested.
11. **AFGHAN FORCES CAPTURE KABUL AIRPORT**
After a five-day bloody battle the Kabul Airport by the rebels early today. Dozens of people were killed and more than 2500 were injured.
12. **GOVT. TO TAKE STERN STEPS**
It has been announced by the government that to check the black-marketing and adulteration of essential goods.
13. **FIRE DESTROYS GOODS WORTH ₹ 25 LAC; CAUSE UNKNOWN**
Goods when two houses in Tilak Nagar caught fire yesterday. The cause of fire which rendered four families homeless, could not be known.
14. **1923 KG HEROIN SEIZED:**
In the biggest -ever drug haul in the country, a consignment of 193 kg of heroin by the Mumbai police from a luxury apartment in Central Mumbai.
15. **TOURISTS ATTACKED BY SHARK**
Last Monday several Australian tourists while surfing off Pasiraman beach.
16. **SUSPECT ARRESTED**
Shahpur police report that the suspect in Nasir Khan murder case
17. **WOMAN, CHILD KILLED IN ROAD MISHAP-SIX INJURED**
A woman and on the spot the six persons were injured, two of them serious, when a tempo in which they were travelling, fell into a pit near Lalpani.
18. **BANKMEN GIVE FREE HAWAI CHAPPALS FOR LEPERS**
Lepers, living in the Asha Deep Colony of the city, on Thursday by the employees of State Bank of India. The Bankmen were celebrating the 42nd anniversary of their branch.
19. **SHOPKEEPER ARRESTED, FINED:**
Ashok Kumar, a shopkeeper of Bilaspur by the police on Tuesday for selling adulterated flour. Later he was produced before the chief Judicial Magistrate by whom he Rs. 5000.

20. ADVANI RELIEVED OF HIS POST:

The BJP President L.K. Advani of his post today after he submitted his resignation in the meeting of the general body of the party.

21. *Rewrite the following passages after changing the Voice:*

01. The early men thought that every misfortune was caused by angry gods. They saw imaginary gods everywhere. They thought of God as a very irritable person who was always losing his temper. If due to some disaster, a large number of people were killed, they would think they had displeased God.

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02. Mr. Lal teaches us English. He was awarded Padma Shri by the President. He is one of the most dedicated teachers we have. Social work interests Mr. Lal very much. He loves his students as he loves his own children. We are lucky to be his pupils. May God bless him!

SPACE FOR ANSWERS

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03. A dove saw a bee fallen in a water tank. It dropped a large leaf into the water. The bee climbed on to the leaf and thanked the dove. A hunter took aim at the dove. The bee stung him. He missed his aim. Now the dove thanked the bee.

SPACE FOR ANSWERS

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04. Once a jester offended the king. The king at once condemned him to death. The jester pleaded for his life but the king refused to alter the sentence. One day the king visited the prison. He asked the jester to choose his manner of death. The clever jester at once said that he would like to die of old age.

SPACE FOR ANSWERS

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05. I explained my case to the doctor. I was seated on a chair against the table by him. I held my hat in my right hand and explained my symptoms. He then gave his advice and helped me liberally.

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06. The emperor was adorned in his royal robes. He was attended by his courtiers. He was escorted to the sea-shore. There he was seated upon a high chair. The chair had been placed there for his reception.

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07. If we look into practical life, we will find that fortune is usually on the side of the industrious. The winds and waves favour the best navigators. Lord Clive began his career in India as a clerk. When he ended his career he had founded the British Empire in the East.

SPACE FOR ANSWERS

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08. A poor Arab saw a spring of sweet water. He had never before tasted such water. He filled his leather bottle from the spring. He wanted to present it to the Khalifa. The courtiers desired to taste the precious water but the Khalifa forbade them. The Khalifa was touched by the Arab's concern for him. He awarded the poor man.

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09. We all know that Columbus discovered America. He was provided with ships and men by the king of Spain. He met with many difficulties on the way. All his fellow men wanted to turn back. But he did not stop till he reached his goal.

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10. It is nice that you are taking your studies seriously. Please don't do it at the cost of your health. Those who do brain work, need regular physical exercise. So don't avoid games. They teach you something which books can never teach, i.e. discipline.

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